

ERA

The Complete Roadmap

Yug's Life & Business Plan • 2026 – 2032+

"The best time to plant a tree was 20 years ago. The second best time is now."

Where You Stand Right Now

YOUR STARTING POSITION

Age: 20 years old, Spring 2026
Education: CS Major, Business Minor, Data Analytics Certificate
Family: Parents (50 & 53) planning permanent move back to Bardoli, Gujarat
Assets: Family land in Bardoli (new house being built), additional family plots, ERA brand website
Goal: Financial freedom — own businesses, passive income, travel, and a life you designed

The Full Timeline at a Glance

Phase	Period	Focus	Target Income
Phase 1	Now → May 2027	Graduate, Save, Prepare	Save \$3,000–5,000 USD
Phase 2	June–Nov 2027	Vacation + First Businesses	₹15,000–30,000/mo
Phase 3	2028	Build & Stack Income Streams	₹60,000–1,00,000/mo
Phase 4	2029	Scale + ERA Launch Prep	₹1,00,000–1,50,000/mo
Phase 5	2030–2031	ERA + Rental Property	₹1,50,000–2,50,000/mo
Phase 6	2032+	Financial Freedom	₹3,00,000+/mo

PHASE 1

Senior Year — Graduate & Prepare

Now • March 2026 → May 2027

This year has one purpose: finish your degree and arrive in India ready to move. Not just ready to visit — ready to execute.

Academics

- Graduate cleanly. No drama, no repeated classes. You need that degree in hand.
- Lean into your Business Minor and Data Analytics certificate — these serve your actual future more than CS classes do.
- Don't stress about internships or CS job applications. That path is not your path and that's completely fine.

Money — Save Aggressively

- Target: \$3,000–5,000 USD saved before graduation. This is your India startup capital.
- Get a part-time job if you don't have one — campus jobs, food delivery, any consistent income.
- Open a Charles Schwab or Wise account now. Both have zero foreign transaction fees and free ATM withdrawals worldwide. You will need this in India.
- Cut unnecessary subscriptions and spending. Every \$100 saved = roughly ₹8,500 in India.

India Prep — Research From the US

- Search: 'Bardoli taluka land rates 2026', 'RERA Gujarat plot buying process', 'South Gujarat real estate growth zones'
- Join r/IndiaInvestments and r/Gujarat on Reddit. Read without posting at first. Absorb.
- Learn key Gujarati land/business terms: 7/12 Utara (land ownership doc), Jantri rates (govt land rates), Stamp Duty, Registry, GIDC.
- Follow 5–10 Indian indie fragrance brands on Instagram. Study their content, pricing, and storytelling for ERA research.
- Look up fragrance suppliers in Kannauj, UP and Surat. Just browse — no contact yet.

ERA Brand — Slow Build

- Your HTML website is already started — keep improving it in your free time.

- Define the brand story: ERA = Yug = an age or epoch. Each scent = a different era. This narrative is your competitive edge.
- Don't spend money on ERA yet. Just sharpen the vision.

PHASE 2

The India Transition

June 2027 → November/December 2027 • 6 Months

This is the most important phase of the entire plan. These 6 months set the foundation for everything that follows. Get this right.

Month 1 — June 2027: Full Vacation. Zero Business.

You have not had a real vacation since you moved to America. You finished four years of college in a foreign country. Give yourself permission to actually rest.

- Visit family you haven't seen properly in years.
- Travel within Gujarat — Surat, Ahmedabad, Dwarka, Somnath, Saputara, Gir. See it with adult eyes.
- Eat everything. Sleep properly. Sit with your parents.
- Let your nervous system decompress. A clear mind makes better business decisions than an exhausted one.

Month 2 — July 2027: Get Oriented

Paperwork First (Week 1–2)

- Update Aadhar card address to Bardoli.
- Get a PAN card if you don't have one — apply at protean-tinpan.com or nearest NSDL center.
- Open an Indian bank account in your name — HDFC or SBI, both have good business banking.
- Get a Jio or Airtel SIM card with a data plan.

Understand Your Land (Week 3–4)

- Sit with your parents and go through every family plot. For each one: exact location, size (sq. meters, guntha, vigha), whose name it is legally registered in, what was paid, estimated current value.
- Understand the ownership structure clearly — Gujarati family property can involve multiple names. Know this before you start making plans around it.
- Don't make any decisions yet. Information gathering only.

Month 3 — August 2027: Deep Research

Real Estate Education

- Visit 3–4 local real estate agents in Bardoli. Tell them you're interested in buying and selling plots. Ask everything — how does a transaction work, what documents are needed, what are jantri vs. market rates, which areas are growing fastest.
- Visit the Bardoli Taluka office and Sub-Registrar office with a family member. Just observe. Understand what happens there.
- Find and meet a CA (Chartered Accountant). Have a 30-minute conversation about sole proprietorship registration, GST, and basic small business taxes. A good CA in Bardoli costs ₹5,000–12,000/year. This person becomes one of your most important ongoing relationships.

Food Cart Research

- Walk Bardoli's main market areas every day for one week at different times — morning, lunch rush, evening.
- Note: Where are the crowds? Which carts are always packed? What's missing? What do people pay?
- Talk to existing vendors casually. Ask what they sell per day, where they got their cart, what their biggest headaches are.
- Identify your top 3 target locations for a cart. Write them down with reasoning.

By End of August You Should Know:

- Exactly what plots you own and approximate current market value of each
- How a full real estate transaction works in Gujarat, start to finish
- The 3 best food cart locations in Bardoli and what food would work at each
- Who your CA will be

Month 4 — September 2027: Launch Food Cart #1

Why starting here and not real estate: A cart gives fast feedback and fast cash. It teaches you employee management, cash tracking, and supplier relationships — skills you need for everything else. Real estate moves slowly. A cart gives you active income while you wait for the right property deal.

Step-by-Step Launch

Step	Action	Budget
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1	Buy the cart — local fabricators in Surat or Bardoli make custom carts	₹25,000–40,000
2	Choose your food — high margin, consistent demand (pav bhaji, dabeli, sandwich, juice, chaas)	—
3	FSSAI registration — apply at fssai.gov.in . Mandatory for all food businesses	₹100/year
4	Gumasta license — local municipal office. Your local business license	₹2,000–5,000
5	Hire one person — ideally referred by family or trusted local contact	₹8,000–12,000/mo
6	Stock setup and first supply run	₹8,000–15,000

- First two weeks: Work the cart yourself alongside your employee. Learn every part before handing it off.
- Week 3 onward: Employee runs it daily. You visit twice — morning to supply, evening to collect cash and check inventory.
- Track every single day: stock in vs. cash out. A notebook is fine at first.

Total Cart #1 Launch Budget: ₹80,000–1,20,000

Month 5 — October 2027: Stabilize

- Do not expand yet. Let the first cart run a full month and observe everything.
- Is the employee reliable? Is daily cash matching expected revenue? What sells fastest? What gets wasted?
- Have your CA set up your sole proprietorship registration.
- Start looking at specific plots — not to buy yet, just to track prices and movement in areas that interest you.
- Begin ERA research: Contact 1–2 fragrance suppliers in Surat or Kannauj. Just conversations — ask about minimum order quantities, custom formulation, pricing. No commitment.

Month 6 — November 2027: Decision Time

By the end of month 6, you answer these questions:

Question	If Yes →	If No →
Is Cart #1 profitable and running smoothly?	Plan Cart #2 launch	Fix the problem first

Do you understand the real estate market well enough to buy?	Identify first target plot	Keep learning 1 more month
Are you building momentum and feel grounded here?	Stay. Skip masters.	Reassess — both paths remain open

Honest prediction: You will want to stay.

A US Masters costs \$40,000–50,000+. If your businesses are showing real traction after 6 months, that money is better invested in your next plot or your rental property.

PHASE 3

Building the Foundation

January 2028 → December 2028 • Full Year

You have 6 months of India living under your belt. You know how things work. Now you build.

Real Estate — First Independent Move

- Work with your family to sell one existing plot. Even if the margin is not huge, go through the entire process yourself: buyer search, negotiation, documentation, registration, stamp duty payment, everything.
- This hands-on education is worth more than the profit on that first deal.
- After the sale, identify a growth-area plot to buy and flip — near GIDC expansion zones, new road development, or Surat's expanding outskirts.
- Target profit on first independent flip: ₹1–3 lakhs. Small but real, and you'll know how it works.
- Start tracking Surat suburb and South Gujarat land price movements in a simple spreadsheet. Your data analytics background makes this your edge over local competitors who work on gut feel alone.

Food Carts — Controlled Expansion

- If Cart #1 has run profitably for 3+ months, launch Cart #2 in Month 2 of this phase.
- Different location, different food item, same operational system.
- By mid-year: launch Cart #3.
- Target by end of 2028: 3 carts running, each generating ₹15,000–25,000/month net.

3 carts combined: ₹45,000–75,000/month

Digital Services — New Income Stream

Bardoli and South Gujarat is full of textile traders, sweet shops, wedding vendors, and local manufacturers with zero digital presence. You can fix that.

Service	One-Time Fee	Monthly Retainer
Basic website build	₹8,000–20,000	₹3,000–6,000/mo
Google Business setup + optimization	₹2,000–5,000	—

Instagram setup + content (1 month)	₹5,000–10,000	₹3,000–5,000/mo
Full digital package (web + social + Google)	₹15,000–30,000	₹5,000–8,000/mo

- Land just 5 retainer clients = ₹15,000–40,000/month of mostly passive income.
- You already built your own website using AI tools. That is genuinely enough to serve a local business owner who has never touched a computer.
- Your English fluency and US background makes you instantly credible to local business owners.

ERA Cologne — Getting Serious

- Visit Kannauj, UP if possible — even a 2-day trip. Meet real perfumers, smell samples, understand the process.
- Commission your first custom fragrance samples. Budget ₹15,000–25,000 for development of 2–3 scents.
- Get ERA on a proper hosted domain — Shopify India or WordPress. Budget ₹3,000–5,000/year.
- Do not launch publicly yet. Get the product right before anything goes live.
- Content creation: Start building the ERA Instagram with brand story content, no products yet. Just building the audience.

Skills to Build This Year

- Basic Tally software or Excel accounting — understand your own numbers in every business.
- How to read a 7/12 Utara and property sale documents — you will sign things, understand what you're signing.
- Instagram Reels content creation — ERA brand building and digital services both need this.

End of 2028 Income Target

Source	Monthly (Estimate)
3 Food Carts	₹45,000–75,000
Digital Services (5 clients)	₹15,000–30,000
Real estate (averaged monthly)	₹10,000–20,000
TOTAL	₹70,000–1,25,000

PHASE 4
Scaling Up
2029 • Full Year

Two years of India operations under your belt. You know what works. Now you pour energy into the winners and prepare ERA for real launch.

Food Carts — Target 5

- Scale from 3 to 5 carts by mid-year.
- At this point you should have a trusted senior employee or manager overseeing the daily operations across all carts — you are the owner, not the operator.
- Monthly net from 5 carts: ₹75,000–1,25,000/month.

Real Estate — Active Portfolio

- Move from family plots to actively buying and selling on your own account.
- Target 2–3 plot transactions in 2029. Even at ₹1–2 lakh profit each, that's ₹2–6 lakhs in the year.
- Start seriously evaluating a 1–2 BHK flat in a new society — either in Surat outskirts or a nice part of Bardoli/Vyara — for rental income.
- A 1BHK in Surat outskirts rents for ₹8,000–18,000/month. Purchase price: ₹25–40 lakhs. This is your first passive income asset.
- Network with Surat developers, attend local real estate events. Build your reputation as someone serious in the space.

ERA Cologne — Final Prep for Launch

- Product is finalized: 2–3 scents, properly formulated, tested, packaged.
- Bottles and packaging ordered from Firozabad (glass) or Mumbai suppliers. Budget ₹80–150 per unit.
- All registrations done: cosmetic product registration under Drugs & Cosmetics Act, GST.
- Website fully ready on Shopify India or custom domain.
- Instagram has been building quietly — aim for 1,000–5,000 engaged followers before launch.

Digital Services — Grow or Outsource

- By now you have a track record. Raise retainer rates slightly for new clients.

- Hire a local fresher to handle content creation and basic tasks under your direction — this frees you to manage strategy, not execution.

End of 2029 Income Target

Source	Monthly (Estimate)
5 Food Carts	₹75,000–1,25,000
Digital Services	₹20,000–40,000
Real Estate (averaged)	₹15,000–30,000
TOTAL	₹1,10,000–1,95,000

PHASE 5

Multiple Streams Running

2030 → 2031

ERA Cologne — Launch

- Launch with 2–3 scents, 100 units each as your first batch.
- Sell exclusively through Instagram and your website for the first 3 months. Prove demand before approaching platforms.
- Once you have 50+ genuine reviews and consistent sales, apply to sell on Nykaa and Amazon India.
- Price point: ₹800–2,500 per bottle depending on concentration (EDT, EDP). Premium but accessible.
- ERA's storytelling advantage: Each scent represents an era. Yug = ERA. The brand name is your name's literal meaning — that is a genuine story no competitor can copy.

Rental Property — First Passive Asset

- If you purchased the flat in 2029, it's now generating ₹8,000–18,000/month with minimal involvement.
- This is the beginning of real passive income — money coming in whether you work that month or not.
- Reinvest rental income plus plot flip profits into a second property when opportunity arises.

Fast Casual Restaurant — Plant the Seed

You mentioned wanting to bring something like Chipotle or In-N-Out to India. The right version of this idea:

- Not in Bardoli — in Surat, where the young professional and college crowd can support it.
- Not a copy of an American brand — your own clean, fast casual concept with consistent quality, good branding, and ₹150–250 price points.
- By 2030–2031 you have capital, operational experience from 5 food carts, and a network. This is when to start planning it seriously.
- Start small: one location, test the model, then expand.

End of 2031 Income Target

Source	Monthly (Estimate)
Food Carts (5, mostly managed)	₹75,000–1,00,000
ERA Cologne	₹30,000–80,000
Rental Property	₹10,000–20,000
Real Estate Transactions	₹20,000–40,000 avg.
Digital Services	₹15,000–25,000
TOTAL	₹1,50,000–2,65,000

PHASE 6

Financial Freedom

2032 and Beyond • Age 26+

This is the life you described. Not a dream — a realistic outcome of executing the plan above consistently.

- Food cart business is largely self-running with a manager. You oversee, not operate.
- ERA is a recognized indie fragrance brand with national reach on Nykaa and Amazon India.
- Real estate portfolio generating both transaction profits and monthly rental income.
- Fast casual restaurant in Surat is either open or in serious planning.
- You are 26 years old with a real business portfolio, financial independence, and the ability to take vacations, buy the things you want, and invest in what comes next.

What Financial Freedom Actually Looks Like at This Stage

- Monthly income of ₹2,50,000–4,00,000+ across all sources.
- Enough passive income (rental + managed businesses) that you don't need to grind every day.
- Capital available to make bigger moves — more properties, restaurant expansion, ERA international.
- The flexibility to travel, spend on what matters to you, and keep building on your own terms.

Non-Negotiable Habits — Throughout Everything

These are not optional. Every business failure story shares at least one of these being ignored.

Habit	Why It Matters
Talk to your CA every month	Stay on top of taxes and compliance from day one. Surprises in Indian taxation can be expensive.
Track every rupee	Simple spreadsheet: income in, expenses out, profit. Every business, every month. No exceptions.
Separate bank accounts per business	Never mix personal and business money. One account per venture from day one.
Reinvest early profits aggressively	The temptation to spend when money starts coming in is real. Reinvest for the first 2 years.
Stay close to your parents' network	They have built relationships in Gujarat over decades. Doors open through people, not applications.
Review what's working quarterly	Every 3 months: What made money? What didn't? Double down on winners, cut losers.
Never sign anything you don't understand	Especially property documents. Your CA or a lawyer reads it first. Always.

One Last Thing

You are 20 years old.

You have a US degree, a house to live in rent-free, family land, parents who are supportive, and a business mind that is already thinking in the right direction.

Most people your age in Bardoli are just starting their first salaried job at ₹15,000/month. You are planning a portfolio of businesses, a cologne brand, and a real estate operation — before you have even moved there.

The feeling of being lost right now? That goes away when you have direction and momentum. This plan gives you both.

Give yourself the first month to just breathe. Then execute one thing at a time. The rest will follow.

— *ERA begins now.*